

Town of Arlington · 2026 Annual Town Meeting
May 6, 2026

Warrant Article 67

Hardy School HVAC Feasibility Study and Schematic Design

FY27 Appropriation Request

\$375,000

Julie Wayman, Deputy Town Manager - Finance

Why are we considering this?

- The Hardy School HVAC (existing buildings) is nearing end of life.
 - The Town supports the climate actions set out in our Net Zero Action Plan.
 - We expect grant funding to make a new electric system cost-competitive with gas replacement.
-

Article 67 appropriates \$375,000 to fund a study and schematic design to make the best decision for the town.

Due to our acceptance into the MSBA Accelerated Repair Program, the town will receive a 43% reimbursement (~\$161,250), resulting in a final cost of \$213,750.

We will evaluate four options - each with a different outcome.

Gas (No A/C)

COST TO ARLINGTON

\$3.97M

No grants available

Air Conditioning
Net Zero Aligned
MSBA Eligible
IRA Direct Pay
Green School Works

Gas + Air Conditioning

COST TO ARLINGTON

\$8.87M

No grants available

✓ Air Conditioning
Net Zero Aligned
MSBA Eligible
IRA Direct Pay
Green School Works

Air Source Heat Pumps

COST TO ARLINGTON

\$4.52M

\$10.0M before grants

✓ Air Conditioning
✓ Net Zero Aligned
✓ MSBA Eligible
✓ Climate Leaders Eligible
IRA Direct Pay
Green School Works

LOWEST COST

Geothermal

COST TO ARLINGTON

\$3.71M

\$13.2M before grants

✓ Air Conditioning
✓ Net Zero Aligned
✓ MSBA Eligible
✓ IRA Direct Pay
✓ Climate Leaders Eligible
✓ Green School Works

Tonight starts a deliberate process.

1

May 6, 2026

Town Meeting votes YES on Article 67

2

Summer 2026

MSBA assigns project OPM and Designer. Feasibility study begins.

3

Spring 2027

Construction vote at Town Meeting as part of Capital Plan

The impact of a NO vote.

- 1 Replacement happens regardless — potentially as a costly emergency
- 2 Arlington exits grant and incentive programs already underway — MSBA, Green School Works, DOER, IRA, MassSave all require advance planning
- 3 Opportunity to make progress on Arlington's Net Zero Action Plan goals missed until next replacement, approximately 20 years

“YES” authorizes \$375,000 to determine the best path forward for Hardy School's HVAC replacement.

- 1 Preserves eligibility for MSBA, IRA Direct Pay, MassSave, Climate Leaders, and Green School Works funding**
- 2 Returns to Town Meeting in Spring 2027 with a full design and cost picture — no construction is authorized tonight**
- 3 Positions Hardy School for air conditioning and long-term Net Zero alignment**
- 4 Avoids a costlier, unplanned emergency gas replacement with no funding offsets**